

[NT Lesson 8](#): The Sermon on the Mount: “A More Excellent Way” (See NTL6 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To encourage us to come unto Christ by applying the principles he taught in the Sermon on the Mount.

1. Jesus teaches the Beatitudes to his disciples.

- Read [Mathew 5:1-12](#). “The word *beatitude* comes from the Latin *beatus*, which means fortunate, happy, or blessed.” What does it mean to be “poor in spirit”? (See footnote 3b “IE **poor in pride, humble in spirit**,” and [3 Nephi 12:3](#).) Why is it important to be humble? How can we become more humble? How have you been comforted in times of mourning? (See [John 14:26-27](#); [Mosiah 18:8-9](#).) What does it mean to be meek? (See footnote 5a “To be gentle, forgiving, or benevolent”.) How can we develop meekness? (See [Mosiah 3:19](#); [Alma 7:23](#); [Alma 13:28](#).) What can we do to “hunger and thirst after righteousness”? (See also [3 Nephi 12:6](#).) How can we show mercy to others? Why do we need mercy from the Lord? (See [Alma 42:13-15](#).) What does it mean to have a pure heart? How can we purify our hearts? (See [Helaman 3:35](#); [Moses 6:57](#).) How can we be peacemakers in our homes and communities? Why are righteous people sometimes persecuted? How should we respond to persecution? (See [Matt. 5:44](#).)

2. Jesus declares that his disciples are “the salt of the earth” and “the light of the world.”

- Read [Matthew 5:13-16](#). What are some uses for salt? How can Latter-day Saints be “the salt of the earth”? (See [D&C 103:9-10](#).) How can Latter-day Saints be “the light of the world”? How do we as Church members sometimes put our light under a bushel? • [3 Nephi 18:24](#). “Behold I am the light which ye shall hold up—that which ye have seen me do...”

3. Jesus teaches a higher law than the law of Moses.

- Read [Matthew 5:17-48](#). “Think not that I am come to destroy the law ... I am not come to destroy, but to fulfill.”
†1 The Law
- Matthew 5:19 “Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men to do so ...”
- JST Matthew 5:21 “so to do, he shall in no wise be saved in the kingdom of heaven ...”

Ye have heard that it was said ...

But I say unto you.

- Matt. 5:21-22. **†2**. “Without a Cause” **†3**. Pres. Monson **†4**. Elder Scott **†5**. Elder Oaks
How do feelings of anger affect our relationship with God? What can we do to control negative feelings?
- Matt. 5:23-24. “Leave there thy gift before the altar ... first be reconciled to thy brother, and then ... offer thy gift.”
How might this apply to us? (See [Matthew 18:15](#) and [D&C 64:8-11](#).)
- Matt. 5:27-28. “Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not commit adultery: ...”
What are some results of unclean thoughts? (See [D&C 63:16](#).)
What can we do to keep our thoughts pure?
- Matt. 5:29-30. “And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee”. (See Matt. 5:30b JST footnote)
- Matt. 5:33-37. “But I say unto you, Swear not at all”. **†6**. Elder Bruce R. McConkie
- Matt. 5:38-42. “Ye have heard ... An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth”. (See [Leviticus 24:17-21](#).)
What principles did Jesus teach when he spoke of turning the other cheek?
- Matt. 5:43-47. “Ye have heard ... Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy.”
How can we develop love for our enemies? (See [Moroni 7:47-48](#).)
How will our lives change when we love our enemies? How might their lives change?
- Matt. 5:48. “Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect.” (See Footnote 48b.)
†7. President Joseph Fielding Smith **†8**. Elder Dallin H. Oaks
How does the Savior’s Atonement help us reach perfection? (See [Moroni 10:32-33](#); [D&C 76:68-70](#).)
How do the teachings in the Sermon on the Mount help us “come unto Christ, and be perfected in him”?

Next Week: L9 Seek Ye First the Kingdom of God”; See L9: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **The Law:** “The law of Moses had been ‘given to the children of Israel, ... for they were a stiffnecked people, quick to do iniquity, and slow to remember the Lord their God.’ It was ‘a law of performances and of ordinances, ... which [the Israelites] were to observe strictly from day to day, to keep them in remembrance of God and their duty towards him’ ([Mosiah 13:29-30](#)). Those who understood the law ‘[looked] forward with steadfastness unto Christ, until the law [was] fulfilled. For, this end was the law given’ ([2 Nephi 25:24-25](#)).

“The Savior fulfilled the law of Moses when he atoned for our sins (Alma 34:13-16). After the Atonement, the people were no longer commanded to make animal sacrifices, which had been required as part of the law of Moses to point to the atoning sacrifice of Jesus Christ. Instead, the people were commanded to ‘offer a sacrifice ... a broken heart and a contrite spirit’ ([3 Nephi 9:19-20](#)).

“Jesus said that his disciples’ righteousness should ‘exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees’ ([Matthew 5:20](#)). What was lacking from the ‘righteousness’ of the scribes and Pharisees? (They focused only on outward appearances of the law and ignored the importance of inner faithfulness. If they had observed the law as it was given, they would have recognized Jesus as the Messiah.)” (*Lesson Manual*)

†2. **“Without a Cause”:** “Note that the phrase ‘without a cause’ does not appear in the [Joseph Smith Translation of Matthew 5:22](#) or in [3 Nephi 12:22](#).) How is the commandment to avoid anger a higher law than the commandment against murder? How do feelings affect our relationship with God? What can we do to control feelings of anger and seek to eliminate them from our lives?” (*Lesson Manual*)

†3. **President Thomas S. Monson:** “ ‘Anger doesn’t solve anything. It builds nothing, but it can destroy everything.’ ... To be angry is to yield to the influence of Satan. No one can make us angry. It is our choice. If we desire to have a proper spirit with us at all times, we must choose to refrain from becoming angry. I testify that such is possible.” (“[School Thy Feelings, O My Brother](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2009, 68)

†4. **Elder Richard G. Scott:** “The inspiring influence of the Holy Spirit can be overcome or masked by strong emotions, such as anger, hate, passion, fear, or pride. When such influences are present, it is like trying to savor the delicate flavor of a grape while eating a jalapeño pepper. Both flavors are present, but one completely overpowers the other. In like manner, strong emotions overcome the delicate promptings of the Holy Spirit. (“[To Acquire Spiritual Guidance](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2009)

†5. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “My widowed mother understood that principle. ‘Pray about your feelings,’ she used to say. She taught her three children to pray for the right kind of feelings about their experiences—positive or negative—and about the people they knew. If our feelings are good, we are more likely to have appropriate desires, to take right actions, and to act for the right reasons.” (*Pure in Heart*, 151)

†6. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “Under the Mosaic law the taking of oaths was so common and covered such a variety of circumstances that, in practice, little verity attended statements that were not made with an oath... Under the perfect law of Christ every man’s word was his bond, and all spoken statements are as true as though an oath attended each spoken word” (*The Mortal Messiah*, 4 vols. [1979-81], 2:140).

†7. **President Joseph Fielding Smith:** “I believe the Lord meant just what he said: that we should be perfect, as our Father in heaven is perfect. That will not come all at once, but line upon line, and precept upon precept, example upon example, and even then not as long as we live in this mortal life, for we will have to go even beyond the grave before we reach that perfection and shall be like God.

“But here we lay the foundation. Here is where we are taught these simple truths of the gospel of Jesus Christ, in this probationary state, to prepare us for that perfection. It is our duty to be better today than we were yesterday, and better tomorrow than we are today... If we are keeping the commandments of the Lord, we are on that road to perfection” (*Doctrines of Salvation*, comp. Bruce R. McConkie, 3 vols. [1954-56], 2:18-19; see also D&C 93:11-14, 19-20).

†8. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “From such teachings we conclude that the Final Judgment is not just an evaluation of a sum total of good and evil acts—what we have done. It is an acknowledgement of the final effect of our acts and thoughts—what we have become... The gospel of Jesus Christ is a plan that shows us how to become what our Heavenly Father desires us to become.” (“[The Challenge to Become](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2000.)

Recommended Reading:

1. President Thomas S. Monson, “[School Thy Feelings, O My Brother](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2009, 68.
2. Elder Eduardo Gavarret, “[Yes, Lord, I Will Follow Thee](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2014, 37.
3. Elder Dallin H. Oaks, “[The Challenge to Become](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2000, 32.

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